

What Actually Moves a Seller From **Close to Yes**

Price gets your offer read. These are the details that make it feel easier, safer, and more likely to close.

01

Contingencies

- Every contingency is where a seller pictures the deal falling apart, not just paperwork.
- If your lender is genuinely confident, waiving the appraisal contingency can read as real strength.
- Can't waive inspection outright? A shorter window still signals that you are not stalling.

RISK

02

Timeframe

- Find out the seller's ideal close date before you write, not after.
- A 45-day ask against a 21-day offer is a timing mismatch that can lose the deal.
- A short, flexible rent-back can outweigh a slightly higher number without one.

RHYTHM

03

The Agent

- Your agent's reputation is working before the seller ever reads your offer.
- Ask whether your agent has worked with the listing agent before, or knows them at all.
- Responsive and easy to work with gets remembered when offers are close.

RELATIONSHIP



FROM JULIA

"I've watched a slightly lower offer beat a slightly higher one because it was just easier. Sellers remember easier."

This is what I look for with my buyers before the offer goes in, while there is still room to make every detail count.

BEFORE IT GOES IN

✓ Know the seller's preferred close date.

✓ Name the protections that matter most.

✓ Make sure the lender and proof of funds are ready.

THREE QUIETER SIGNALS

Small details that make an offer feel more certain.

SIGNAL 01

Set a real escalation ceiling.

Choose it before emotions take over, so the number reflects your strategy—not the pressure of the moment.

SIGNAL 02

Use earnest money intentionally.

A stronger deposit can signal commitment and make the entire offer feel more credible.

SIGNAL 03

Have proof of funds ready.

Current and included is stronger than promised. Pair it with a lender who is ready to answer the phone.